BEFORE YOU PLAY · POSTURE AND HAND SHAPE · LEARN

Posture and hand shape

REMEMBER Sit tall, forearms level with the keys, a round hand on the fingertips.

1 Finger numbers

★☆☆

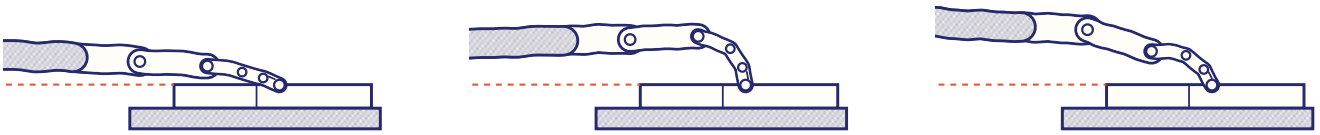
Write the number of each finger. They are the same in both hands. The first is done.

FINGER	NUMBER	FINGER	NUMBER
thumb	1	ring finger	
index finger		little finger	
middle finger			

2 Which hand is round?

★☆☆

Circle the round hand.



A B C

3 Too low, too high, or right?

★★☆

Write too low, too high or right.

WHAT YOU SEE	THE STOOL IS
The elbows are well below the keys; the forearms go uphill.	too low
The forearms are level with the keys.	
The elbows are above the keys; the wrists drop down to them.	

4 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

The thumb is finger 1 in both hands.	T	F
Play with the flat pads of your fingers.	T	F
Your wrists can rest on the wood in front of the keys.	T	F
Your feet stay flat on the floor.	T	F

Answers: 1 thumb 1, index 2, middle 3, ring 4, little 5 · 2 B · 3 too low, right, too high · 4 T, F, F, T.

Date _____

BEFORE YOU PLAY · POSTURE AND HAND SHAPE · USE

My posture week

REMEMBER The 30-second check, every time you sit down: stool, body, shoulders, hands, breathe.

1 The 30-second check

★☆☆

Every time you sit down to practise, check each line and tick a circle. One circle per day.

	MON TO SUN
Stool: forearms level with the keys	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Body: front half of the stool, feet flat	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Shoulders: lifted, then dropped	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Hands: round, knuckles up	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Breathe out, then play	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

2 Six warm-ups

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Do each warm-up before you play. Tick a circle each day.

	MON TO SUN
Rag doll	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Elbow wings	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Arm glide	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Arm drop	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Knuckle bridge	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Wrist balloon	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

3 Teacher's check

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Your teacher ticks what is already right and circles one thing to work on this week.

	RIGHT	WORK ON
Stool height and distance	☐	☐
Back and shoulders	☐	☐
Round hand: knuckles up, fingertips, level wrist	☐	☐

Date _____